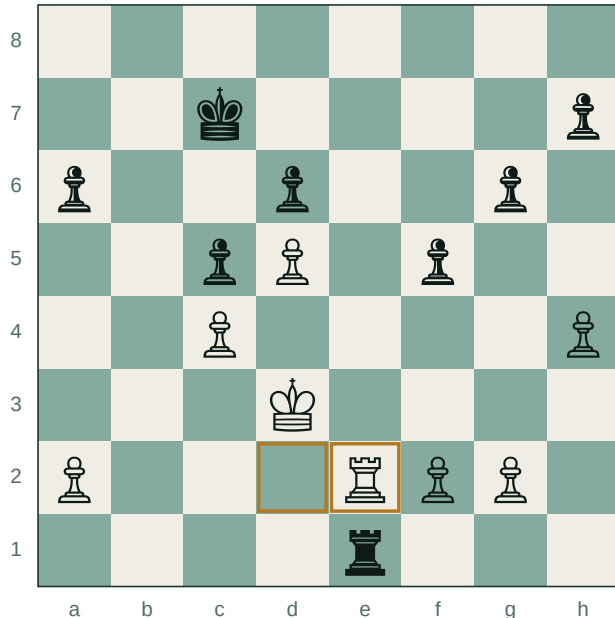


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 28

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Re2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Rxe2 29. Kxe2 Kb6 30. Kf3 Ka5 31. a3 Ka4

28...Rxe2 The rook captures the rook on e2. Recorded reply: **29.Kxe2**.

29...Kb6 The king moves from c7 to b6. Recorded reply: **30.Kf3**.

30...Ka5 The king moves from b6 to a5. Recorded reply: **31.a3**.

31...Ka4 The king moves from a5 to a4.

At the end, nominal material is White 6 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +0:** the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.